

Communication Skills and Computer Applications

Science

May, 2026

Communication Skills and Computer Applications (A06902)

Short Title: Comm Skills & Comp Application
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster IT
Author MCAHILL
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will teach the student how to communicate effectively using written and oral media. Students will be shown how to find and reference reliable information from a variety of sources. The student will gain a competency in the Microsoft Windows operating environment, as well as a proficiency in file and data management. An introduction to the basic principles of word processing, spreadsheets and presentations will be given. Report writing and presentation skills will be acquired, such that the student can competently present material in a format acceptable for reports and presentations.

Programmes

COMP-0578	BSc in Forestry (WD_SFORS_D)	1 / 1 / M
COMP-0578	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	1 / 1 / M
COMP-0578	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	1 / 1 / M

Indicative Content

- Research and referencing: introduction to the sourcing of information, plagiarism and correct referencing
- Writing skills: planning, structuring and executing a piece of written communication, proof-reading skills, editing skills
- Communication in teams: stages in team-building, composition of successful teams
- Structure of formal meetings: role of secretary, role of chairperson, function of agenda, minutes, standing orders, motions
- Oral presentations: identifying the audience, defining objectives, structuring a presentation
- MS Windows environment: effective and efficient file management, privacy and security
- Word processing: creating, editing, formatting, saving and printing documents; creating and editing tables, table of contents and manipulation of images in documents
- Spreadsheets: creating, editing, formatting, saving and printing workbooks and worksheets; sorting data, using formulas, charts, filters and links
- Presentations: creating, editing, formatting, saving and printing presentations; use of images, animations and transitions in presentations

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Identify information from reliable sources and use an appropriate referencing system to generate a bibliography.
2. Reproduce letters, reports, minutes and memoranda using word processing software.
3. Report information orally using presentation software.
4. Explain data using spreadsheet software.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- IT practicals.
- Group work.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>In-Class Assessment</i>	30%	4
<i>Presentation</i>	20%	3
<i>Portfolio</i>	50%	1,2

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Poor presentation and/or poorly communicated and formatted assignments.

40%-49%: Presentation adequate, communication and technology use adequate.

50%-59%: Presentation of material is competent with clear ideas and logical structure, few if any grammatical and spelling errors. Competent display of IT skills.

60%-69%: Presentation of material is logical and persuasive, indicates strong communication and technical skills.

70%-100%: Excellent communication of material supported by use of correct conventions and excellent use of technology.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Practical	48	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- McClave, H. _Communications for Business._ . 4th. Dublin: Gill & McMillan Ltd, 2008.

Supplementary Material

- Kennedy, J.A. _Complete ECDL 5_. 2nd ed.. Dublin: Gill & Macmillan, 2011.

Requested Resources

- Room Type: Computer Lab